

module-08-yoga - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

Module 8 — Yoga and the Body (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Yoga* · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Patañjali's eight limbs and safe āsana practice.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 8's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Ask: “*What do you think yoga is?*” (Likely answer: stretching.) Project Patañjali's definition: “*Yogaḥ citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ*” — Yoga is the stilling of the mind's fluctuations. (Yogasūtra 1.2). “*Stretching is one of EIGHT limbs of yoga. Today we map all eight.*”

Core idea · 15 min

Patañjali's eight limbs of yoga:

Limb	Sanskrit	Modern translation
1	Yama	Ethical restraints (5: non-violence, truthfulness, non-stealing, sexual restraint, non-greed)
2	Niyama	Personal observances (5: purity, contentment, austerity, study, surrender)
3	Āsana	Posture
4	Prāṇāyāma	Breath regulation
5	Pratyāhāra	Withdrawal of senses
6	Dhāraṇā	Concentration
7	Dhyāna	Meditation
8	Samādhi	Absorbed awareness

Modern yoga in the West = mostly limbs 3 + 4. The full system is much wider.

Demonstration · 10 min

Eight-limb tasting. Brief experience of each limb: 1 minute of *ahimsā* (mental check: anyone you're angry at?), 1 minute of *santoṣa* (gratitude breath), 2 minutes of *āsana* (one pose), 2 minutes of *prāṇāyāma* (alternate-nostril breathing), 1 minute of *pratyāhāra* (eyes closed), 1 minute of *dhyāna* (silent sit).

Source moment · 5 min

Paraphrase Yogasūtra 1.2: “*Yogaḥ citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ*” — “Yoga is the stilling of the mind's fluctuations.” The whole system is in service of mental clarity.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Eight-limb personal mapping. Each student picks ONE limb they want to practice for one week, with one daily action. Pair-share.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“Modern yoga focuses on *āsana*. What's lost by ignoring the other 7 limbs? What might you incorporate?”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you're skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Yoga in your life — what is it really?
- **Day 02** — Yamas — five ethical restraints
- **Day 03** — Niyamas — five personal observances
- **Day 04** — Āsana — what Patañjali actually said
- **Day 05** — Prāṇāyāma — breath physiology
- **Day 06** — Pratyāhāra and Dhāraṇā — turning inward, focusing
- **Day 07** — Dhyāna — meditation as method
- **Day 08** — Samādhi — the goal
- **Day 09** — Modern yoga — what changed, what stayed
- **Day 10** — Personal practice plan + share

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.